LETTER FROM THE EDITOR-IN-CHIEF

If you think a watch is a man's favourite piece of jewellery, you are going with the consensus. As colourful gems and hardstones enjoy a glory moment in the art of high horology, men's watches are celebrating colour with a new-found legitimacy. With hardstone dials emerging as one of the most exciting trends, even the legendary Lionel Messi seems to have gone for goal. He proudly sports a Rolex Daytona "Barbie", which features an 18k yellow-gold case, a pink dial, baguette-cut pink sapphire hour markers and a matching pink-sapphire bezel.

Luxury demands the unique; the true allure of natural gemstones lies in their absolute refusal to conform. Each carries its own colour, inclusions and geological history—qualities that can't be perfectly replicated. Their return to watchmaking captures a shifting mindset among collectors: a demand for personal expression and the effortless prestige of things shaped by nature and time. The country's homegrown watch brand Titan (the world's fifth-largest watchmaker by volume) combines precious stones like diamonds and rubies, and hard stones such as malachite and aventurine for their luxury Nebula collection.

The Jaipur Watch Company, too, honours its maximalist aesthetic with its most recent launch, the Premium Baagh Collection, which makes it to our cover this issue. Inspired by Indian heritage and motifs, it features a sculpted golden tiger on the dial, with a turquoise stone brickwork mosaic as backdrop. Nothing glorifies Rajasthan's craftsmanship quite like the miniature Chhatri set with a ruby jewel. The dial has always been the focal point of a watch, but a stone dial carries an inherent artistry that resonates differently than lacquer or metal.

As buyers respond to wearable art, even legacy brands such as Rolex and Chopard reintroduced stone dials in their Watches and Wonders 2026 collections, to offer more than the mundane. Bold colours continued their march with avant-garde brands such as Moser, Hublot, Richard Mille and Zenith. But with the Holy Trinity of Swiss watchmaking, Patek Philippe, Vacheron Constantin and Audemars Piguet, it was time to honour the back-catalogues. Speaking of high horology back catalogues, Breguet celebrates the 225th anniversary of the tourbillon complication this year, which the brand celebrated with four new tourbillon models that epitomise classic horology.

As luxury watch trends in 2026 coalesce around ultra-thin profiles, smaller case diameters, and heritage revivals, industry hallmarks seem to pull away from hype-driven excess toward understated craftsmanship, mechanical purity, and milestone-driven purchases. The automotive equivalent would probably be the new Mercedes-Benz GLS 450 Night Edition. The standard GLS has always been more formal, all chrome and ceremony; this limited-run version seems to ease up on stuffy protocol. Alpine Grey or Obsidian Black paint is paired with a darkened exterior treatment, turning that enormous grille from flashy to quiet seduction. The Night Edition does not reinvent the GLS; it simply makes excess look refined.

Whatever your style statement, the following pages of the watch special present the perfect matrix of prestige, precision and passion.





Hardstone dials are one of the top trends in High Horology; The Mercedes-Benz GLS 450 Night Edition earns its name more convincingly with Black Nappa leather and Anthracite open-pore oak interiors (Above)

(Aroon Purie)